

WARIS AHMAD FAIZI

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Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech
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EDUCATION

2024–	Ph.D., Sociology, Virginia Tech <i>Areas:</i> Economic Sociology; Digital Sociology; Labor, Work, and Organizations <i>Methods:</i> Quantitative Methods; Computational Social Science
2023	M.A., Sociology, American University of Central Asia
2020	M.A., Economics, OSCE Academy in Bishkek
2015	B.A., Economics, Kabul University

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2025–	Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech
Summer 2025	Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech
2024–25	Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2022–23	Research Intern, Office of the Vice President for Academic Affairs, American University of Central Asia
2021	Research Fellow, Central Asia Program , George Washington University
2021	Research Intern, Center for Research and Graduate Education (CRGE), Kazakh-German University (DKU)
2021	Research Consultant, World Bank Project, Pearl Horizon Consulting

AWARDS & HONORS

2026	Dean's Graduate Scholar, College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences, Virginia Tech
2026	CLAHS Fellowship Award, College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences, Virginia Tech
2026	Center for Humanities Graduate Student Fellowship, Virginia Tech
2025	Patricia and John Edwards Fellowship Award, Virginia Tech
2023	Student Initiative Development Program Fund, Center for Civic Engagement, American University of Central Asia
2022	Erasmus+ Exchange Scholarship, Otto-von-Guericke University (OVGU), Germany
2021	Central Asia Program Research Fellowship, George Washington University
2021	M.A. Sociology Program Full Scholarship, American University of Central Asia
2019	M.A. Economics Program Full Scholarship, OSCE Academy in Bishkek

PUBLICATIONS

Manuscripts under Review

- R3 **Faizi, W. A.**, Kim, D., Dogan, C., Park, S. & Kim, J. *Mapping Workforce Reskilling Urgency in the Age of AI: Occupational and Geographic Patterns Across the United States*. Revise and resubmit at *Telematics and Informatics*. 2026.
- R2 Calasanti, T., **Faizi, W. A.** & King, N. *Age Relations and Intersections*. Under review at *Sociology Compass*. 2026.
- R1 Roos, J. M., **Faizi, W. A.** & Lin, S.-H. *Confidence in Science and Political Institutions, 2010–2024: Four Distinct Patterns of Polarization*. To be submitted to *Socius: Sociological Research for a Dynamic World*. 2026.

Works in Progress

- W6 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Moral Economies of Influencer Culture: Visibility, Value, and Intersectional Precarity*.
- W5 **Faizi, W. A.** *Divergent Value Trajectories: Cultural and Economic Liberalization in the United States, 2004–2024*.
- W4 **Faizi, W. A.** *Platform Labor, Identity, and Inequality: A Systematic Review of Gig Work Through an Intersectional Lens*.
- W3 **Faizi, W. A.** *Social Capital and the Geography of Opportunity: Economic Connectedness, Bias, and Mobility in the United States*.
- W2 **Faizi, W. A.** *Pricing Care Labor: A Computational Systematic Review of How Care Work is Economically and Socially Devalued*.
- W1 Roos, J. M., **Faizi, W. A.** & Lin, S.-H. *Item Level Bias in the NSF-sponsored Science Knowledge Scale, 2006–2024*.

Research Reports

- P2 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Future of the CASA-1000 Electric Megaproject in the Context of the New Afghanistan*. Central Asia Program, George Washington University (2021). centralasiaprogram.org/archives/central-asia-research-paper/
- P1 **Faizi, W. A.** *Impact of Development Projects on Jobs Creation in Afghanistan (2016–2019)*. OSCE Academy in Bishkek (2020). <https://mt.osce-academy.kg/handle/123456789/430>

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- C9 **Faizi, W. A.** *Social Capital and the Geography of Opportunity: Economic Connectedness, Bias, and Mobility in the United States*. Southern Sociological Society (SSS) Annual Meeting (Jacksonville, FL, USA). Apr. 2026.
- C8 **Faizi, W. A.** *Divergent Value Trajectories: Cultural and Economic Liberalization in the United States, 2004–2024*. 42nd Annual GPSS Research Symposium and Exposition, Virginia Tech (Blacksburg, VA, USA). Mar. 2026.
- C7 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Moral Economies of Influencer Culture: Visibility, Value, and Intersectional Precarity*. Eastern Sociological Society (ESS), 96th Annual Meeting (Washington, DC, USA). Mar. 2026.

- C6 **Faizi, W. A.** *Redistribution Gap: Class, Race and Political Ideology in Shaping Attitudes Toward Inequality.* Association for Humanist Sociology (AHS), 49th Annual Meeting (Columbus, OH, USA). Nov. 2025.
- C5 **Faizi, W. A.** *Economic Precarity, Quality of Work Life, and Social Trust: An Empirical Study of the U.S. Workforce (2004–2024).* Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP) Annual Meeting (Chicago, IL, USA). Aug. 2025.
- C4 **Faizi, W. A.** *Public, Private, or Personal: Comparative Impacts of Government, Private, and Self-Employment on Job and Financial Satisfaction in the United States.* Canadian Association for Work and Labour Studies (CAWLS) (Hamilton, ON, Canada). May 2025.
- C3 **Faizi, W. A.** *Digital Transformation and Work Paradigm's Shift: Remote Work's Impact on Social Networks and Integration, Well-being, and Economic Stability in the United States.* Southern Sociological Society (SSS) Annual Meeting (Charlotte, NC, USA). Apr. 2025.
- C2 **Faizi, W. A.** *Efficacy of Human Skills Development as a Source of Regional Competitive Advantage and Economic Development in Afghanistan.* South Asian Economics Students' Meet (SAESM) (Colombo, Sri Lanka). Apr. 2016.
- C1 **Faizi, W. A.** *Afghan Carpets' Export Situation: Challenges and Opportunities.* South Asian Economics Students' Meet (SAESM) (Thimphu, Bhutan). Dec. 2014.

TEACHING

Virginia Tech

- 2024– Graduate Teaching Assistant, SOC 1004: Introductory Sociology, Undergraduate
- 2024– Graduate Teaching Assistant, SOC 3204: Social Research Methods, Undergraduate
- 2024– Graduate Teaching Assistant, AFST 1814: Introduction to African Studies, Undergraduate
- 2024– Graduate Teaching Assistant, AFST 4354: Topics in Africana Studies, Undergraduate

Prior Teaching Appointments

- 2019–21 Lecturer / Instructor, Gawharshad University, Kabul, Afghanistan
- 2019–21 Lecturer / Instructor, Tolo-e-Aftab Institute of Higher Education, Kabul, Afghanistan
- 2016–21 Lecturer / Instructor, Sayed Jamaluddin Afghan Institute of Higher Education, Kabul, Afghanistan
- 2016–18 Lecturer / Instructor, Fanoos Institute of Higher Education, Kabul, Afghanistan

Pedagogical Training

- 2025–26 Future Professoriate / Global Perspectives Program (GPP), Virginia Tech
- Preparing Future Professoriate (3 credits), Fall 2025
 - Contemporary Pedagogy (3 credits), Spring 2026
 - Higher Education 360 (3 credits), Spring 2026

SERVICE

- 2023 Career Development Mentor / Trainer, American University of Central Asia

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Current	American Sociological Association (ASA); Southern Sociological Society (SSS); Eastern Sociological Society (ESS); Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP); Association for Humanist Sociology (AHS); Pacific Sociological Association (PSA)
Affiliations	Dataism Laboratory for Quantitative Finance (DLQF), Virginia Tech; Center for Humanities (CfH), Virginia Tech

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical	R, Python, Stata, SPSS, JMP
Other	SQL and database management, ArcGIS Online, LaTeX (Overleaf), high-performance computing (Virginia Tech ARC)

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & TRAINING

2026	Social Network Analysis, University of California, Davis (Coursera)
2026	Causal Inference, Columbia University (Coursera)
2026	Social and Economic Networks: Models and Analysis, Stanford University (Coursera)
2026	Narrative Economics, Yale University (Coursera)
2026	Best Practices for Mentorship in Teaching, Virginia Tech
2026	Introduction to Geospatial Mapping and ArcGIS Online, Virginia Tech
2026	Manage Your Scholarly Identity Challenge Course, Virginia Tech
2026	Connect to ARC Systems with VSCode; Advanced Research Computing Roadmap, Virginia Tech
2026	The Joyful Journey: Graduate Student and Postdoctoral Scholar Professional Development Series, CIRTl
2025	Day for Data, AI & Analytics Symposium, Center for the Arts, Virginia Tech
2025	Datapalooza 2025: Truth and Accountability in the Age of AI, University of Virginia School of Data Science
2025	Preparing for the Academic Job Market Workshop Series, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
2025	Summer Institute for Undergraduate Education, Virginia Tech
2025	Introduction to LaTeX with Overleaf; Introduction to Database Management and SQL, Virginia Tech
2024	Social & Behavioral Research, CITI Basic Course
2024	Graduate Teaching Assistant (GTA) Workshop Series, Virginia Tech
2021–25	Courses in Python and R, LinkedIn Learning and DataCamp

REFERENCES

Toni Calasanti, Ph.D., FGSA
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Director of Graduate Studies
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